

Daniel Scharf

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Overview:

International education program leader with 10+ years of experience in U.S. and international higher education, including six years working in Japanese universities. Experienced in managing international student programs across the full program lifecycle, including academic and cultural programming, budgets, staffing, student support, partnerships, logistics, assessment, and continuous improvement. MA TESOL with extensive experience collaborating across academic, enrollment, student affairs, and international education functions.

Core Skills:

- Program Management & Stakeholder Coordination
- Curriculum Development & Assessment
- Intercultural Training & Communication
- In-Person, Online, & Hybrid Course Design
- Data-Informed Instruction and Evaluation
- Basic Web Development (HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Ruby, Rails, Python)

Professional Experience:

Program Manager - International Language and Education Center

SUNY Oswego - April 2024-Present

Achievements:

- Led the end-to-end redesign and relaunch of a 3–6 week summer intensive English program, covering curriculum, assessment strategy, learner experience, recruitment, and a budget of up to \$50K; supervised 3 staff
- Restructured the program curriculum into stackable micro-credentials integrating intercultural communication and professional skills
- Designed and launched EASE, a new conditional admission pathway for students just below the English proficiency requirement, from needs analysis through support curriculum, exit criteria, and cross-department approval; first cohort enrolled Fall 2026
- Design and revise credit-bearing English for Academic Purposes curricula, including learning outcomes, assessments, rubrics, and instructional materials, and guide them through institutional governance and approval
- Designed and facilitated intercultural communication training workshops, later redesigned as a self-paced online course
- Analyze enrollment, assessment, and financial data to evaluate program performance and report recommendations to university leadership; collaborate with Admissions, International Student Services, advising, and faculty

Part-Time Lecturer - Academic Literacy

Waseda University Academic Solutions. Oct 2023 - Feb 2024

Achievements:

- Delivered advanced-level curriculum focused on critical thinking, academic literacy, and argumentation

Volunteer Website Coordinator

Online Writing Center Association. Jan 2023 - Dec 2024

Achievements:

- Maintained and updated website content for an international professional organization
- Improved site usability and content structure for conference and publication materials
- Troubleshoot technical issues and supported ongoing digital content delivery

Coordinator - Library Student Support Services

Southern Oregon University. Oct 2021 - June 2022

Achievements:

- Designed and implemented tutor training curriculum to improve instructional quality
- Led cross-departmental collaboration to expand academic support services
- Managed operations and staffing for tutoring programs, including budgeting and program development

Global Teaching Fellow

Tokyo International University. March 2016 - Sept 2021

Achievements:

- Designed and implemented curriculum for academic literacy, research skills, and critical thinking courses
- Co-founder, coordinator, and administrator of Peer Advisers for Writing (PAW) program
- Created Analytical Reading and Thinking (ART) curriculum, that was adopted by the department, to improve student research and analytical skills

English Tutor at Portland State University Intensive English Language Program. May 2013 - June 2015

Portland, Oregon, USA

Achievements / Duties

- Tutoring English language students
- Helping advanced students understand their content course work
- Preparing students for English proficiency tests
- Gaining CRLA Master Level Certification

Business English Instructor

Freiburg, Germany. 2008 - 2010

Achievements:

- Designed customized professional communication training for adult learners using presentations, simulations, and role-play

Education / Certifications:

MA TESOL: Portland State University

BA in History: Southern Oregon University

Web Development: Le Wagon, Tokyo

Effective Teaching Practices in Higher Education – Association of College and University Educators

TEFL Certificate: TEFL WorldWide Prague

Presentations, Achievements, Awards:

October 2022: “‘Use what you have’: Helping Sri Lankan academics create tutoring centers at their universities”

Co-Presenters: Vanessa Armand, Amanda Tolmanek, Romola Rassool, Nadee Mahawaththa. International Writing Center Association (IWCA) Annual Conference, October 2022, Vancouver, Canada

February 2022: “Supporting students with a tutoring center”

Co-Presenters Vanessa Armand, Amanda Tolmanek, Romola Rassool, Nadee Mahawaththa. Presented to professors from universities across Sri Lanka. Online workshops organized through the Accelerating Higher Education Expansion and Development (AHEAD) Operation and the Sri Lankan Ministry of Education

July 2021: “Training of Trainers (ToT) to Develop Academic Literacy among Undergraduates”

Presenter: Vanessa Armand. Presented to professors from universities across Sri Lanka. Online

workshops organized through the Accelerating Higher Education Expansion and Development (AHEAD) Operation and the Sri Lankan Ministry of Education

April 2021: “Academic Literacy in an EMI Context: A Workshop” Presented to professors from universities across Sri Lanka. Online workshops organized through the Accelerating Higher Education Expansion and Development (AHEAD) Operation and the Sri Lankan Ministry of Education

March 2020: “Beyond the Writing Center: Inviting Peer Tutors into the Classroom to Help with the Writing Process” Co-presenter: Alexandra Pellillo. Writing Centers Association of Japan (WCAJ) Symposium Spring 2020, Osaka Japan

February 2020: Poster Presentation “Supporting Students with the PAW Program” Co-Presenter: Alexandra Pellillo. THAI TESOL Annual Conference 2020, Bangkok Thailand

June 2019: “Students Helping Students: An Introduction to the TIU Peer Writing Center, PAW” Co-presenter: Alexandra Pellillo. 6th Annual Conference on Global Higher Education at Lakeland University Japan

January 2019: Co-recipient [w/Vanessa Armand] of *The Mary Finocchiaro Award for Excellence in Unpublished Pedagogical Materials* at TESOL International Conference 2019, for the tutor-training handbook and program assessment materials developed for the Peer Advisers for Writing Program at Tokyo International University

July 2017: “Growing a Curriculum: Blending Analytical Reading and Writing Courses to Maximize Student Success” Co-presenter: Sara Van dan Acker. Saitama JALT Nakasendo English Conference, Tokyo Japan

Training and Micro Credentials:

- May 2026: Effective Teaching Practices in Higher Education
 - Association of College and University Educators (ACUE)
- October 2025: How to Boost Your Productivity with AI Tools (2023)
 - LinkedIn Learning
- July 2025: Social and Behavioral Responsible Conduct of Research
 - Collaborative Institutional Training Initiative (CITI) Program
- February 2024: Conflict Resolution For Beginners
 - LinkedIn Learning
- February 2024: How to Think Strategically
 - LinkedIn Learning
- April 2022: Instructional Design Essentials: Models of ID
 - LinkedIn Learning